

Skills Summary

Teen Numbers — Fixing Swapped Tens and Ones

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Reading 1 ten and some ones

Rule:

A teen number is **1 ten** and some **ones**. Build it and write it in this order: **tens first, ones second**.

1 ten = one full ten-frame = one ten-stick. Then count the loose ones. Write the tens digit in the **left** box and the ones digit in the **right** box:

tens

ones

Example: Build the number that is 1 ten and 4 ones.

Step 1. The first digit counts full ten-frames, so it is 1; the second digit counts the loose dots, so it is 4.

Step 2. Tens first, ones second: 1 ten is 10, and 10 with 4 more is **14**.

Try it: Build the number that is 1 ten and 9 ones.

check: 14

Skill 2 — Fixing a swapped number

How to check for a swap:

1. Count the **tens** in the picture. 2. Count the **ones**. 3. Ask: does the *first* digit match the number of tens?

If the first digit is bigger than the number of full ten-frames, the digits were **swapped**. Put them back the right way round: tens digit first.

Example: A child builds 1 ten and 2 ones, then writes a number whose first digit is 2.

Step 1. The first digit should count the *tens*, and there is only 1 ten — so the two digits were swapped.

Step 2. Swap them back: 1 ten first, then 2 ones, giving 10 with 2 more, which is **12**.

Try it: A child builds 1 ten and 5 ones but writes the 5 first. Write the correct number.

check: 15

Skill 3 — Comparing a swapped pair

Rule:

The same two digits swapped are **not** the same number. To compare, look at the **tens** digit first — more tens always wins.

$<$ means *is less than*. $>$ means *is greater than*.

Example: Compare the number made from 1 ten and 4 ones with the number made from 4 tens and 1 one.

Step 1. Compare the tens first: the first number has 1 ten and the second has 4 tens.

Step 2. 4 tens is more than 1 ten, so the first number is the smaller one: $<$.

Try it: Compare the number made from 6 tens and 1 one with the number made from 1 ten and 6 ones.

check: $>$

(!) Watch out: Teen numbers are *said* ones-first (“six-teen”) but *written* tens-first. Hearing the ones word first is exactly why the digits get swapped — build the ten before you write anything down.